ordination. As such, he sent 22 monks and 33 novices to Ceylon to undergo re-ordination according to the Singhalese tradition. In fact the northern Tai and Burmese chronicles as well as the Kālyaṇī inscriptions document several religious missions to Ceylon from Ava and Pegu. In return, Sīnala monks visited Pegu.

In 1530, the then 16-year-old Tabengshweti (r. ca. 1531–1550) of the Toungoo kingdom decided to reunite Burma. Tabengshweti captured the port city of Bassein in 1535 and went on to attack Pegu. He attacked the city three times, eventually capturing Pegu in 1539. Tabengshweti celebrated his victory over Pegu by decorating the Shwedagon pagoda and other pagodas with plundered gold.

THE HEIR TO BAGAN: THE RISE AND FALL OF AVA (1364–1555)

The Burman kingdom of Ava (1364–1555), the successor state to the Myinsaing (1298–1312), Pinya (1312–1364), and Sagaing (1315–1364) kingdoms, emerged about a century after the fall of Bagan. Ava was founded on January 26, 1365, by a young Burmese nobleman named Thadominpaya (r. ca. 1364–1368) who seized control of an area at the confluence of the Ayeyarwaddy and Myitnge Rivers. Thadominpaya sought to unite the Burman, Mon, and Shans into a single nation as they were under the kings of Bagan. He began by gradually consolidating control over Upper Burma. He led a series of military campaigns to subjugate the cities of Taungdwingyi and Segu between 1365 and 1367. Thadominpaya died during his military campaign to Segu and was succeeded by his brother-in-law Mingyiswasawke (r. ca. 1368–1401). During his long reign, Mingyiswasawke consolidated regional power at Ava by conquering Kyaukse, Meikhtila, Minbu, the Mu valley, and Yamthin. These areas not only provided Ava with a stable source of food but also gave Ava additional manpower reserves. This additional manpower provided Ava with the military strength necessary to wage continuous wars against her neighbors. During the reigns of Mingaung (r. ca. 1401–1422), Thihathu (r. ca. 1422–1425), and Naripati (r. ca. 1442–1468), Ava reached its zenith. Domestic political stability gave the Ava kings the opportunity to wage continued warfare against Hanthawaddy Pegu, Arakan, and the Shan mongs (city-